

Toronto Home Energy Loan Program (HELP) — Sustainability & Cost Reference Note

Source: City of Toronto (toronto.ca), current for 2026. The Home Energy Loan Program (HELP) lets Toronto homeowners borrow up to \$125,000 to pay for home energy improvements. Through the enhanced program, zero-interest loans are available for a limited time.

Repayment terms are up to 15 years, extended to 20 years for retrofits that include rooftop solar PV, geothermal systems, new windows, or electric heat pumps. The loan is repaid through the homeowner's property tax bill as a Local Improvement Charge (LIC) under City by-laws 1105-2013 and 1330-2013, and can be paid off at any time.

Eligible high-impact measures include replacing a furnace with an electric heat pump, insulating from attic to basement, upgrading windows and doors, air sealing (weather stripping and caulking), rooftop solar PV, and geothermal. HELP also helps homeowners stack utility-company and federal rebates.

Property eligibility: you must own a detached, semi-detached, row house, duplex, triplex, or any low-rise residential building of at most three storeys and six units located in Toronto (postal code starting with 'M').

Cost-of-ownership angle: because the loan is repaid as a charge on the property tax bill, a green retrofit becomes a predictable financed carrying cost while lowering monthly energy bills — directly relevant to the true 10-year cost of ownership and to a buyer's sustainability profile.